

Task 5

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Case Study: Phishing Attack on College Students

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers impersonate legitimate organizations to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs. It is one of the most common online threats faced by students.

In a typical phishing scenario, several college students received an email that appeared to be from their university's examination department. The email claimed that their exam registration would be cancelled unless they verified their details immediately. It included a link that looked similar to the official university website. When students clicked the link, they were directed to a fake login page that asked for their email ID, password, and OTP. Believing it to be genuine, many students entered their credentials.

Within hours, their accounts were compromised. The attackers accessed personal data, sent spam emails from their accounts, and attempted unauthorized financial transactions linked to their email IDs.

Phishing attacks usually target students, employees, and senior citizens because they may act quickly under pressure without verifying the authenticity of messages. The consequences include identity theft, financial loss, and data breaches.

This case highlights the importance of checking email addresses carefully, avoiding suspicious links, and enabling two-factor authentication. Awareness and cautious online behavior are the best defenses against phishing attacks.